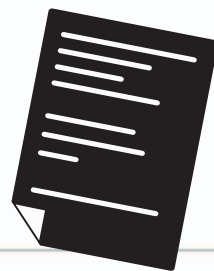


TV/FILM PRODUCER

JOB DESCRIPTION

The producer is the linchpin of any TV or film production. The role involves assessing scripts, buying the rights to adapt books for the screen, and securing finance before filming. The producer hires a director and crew, organizes the shooting schedule, and is responsible for ensuring that the project is completed on time and on budget, using a blend of business acumen, creativity, and technical expertise.



SALARY

Assistant producer ★★☆☆☆
Experienced producer ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Most jobs based in large cities •
Fiercely competitive industry •
Permanent, salaried jobs becoming rare •
Growing opportunities in cable and satellite TV

▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **TV/FILM DIRECTOR** *see pp. 44–45*
- ▶ **CAMERA OPERATOR** *see pp. 48–49*
- ▶ **SOUND ENGINEER** *see pp. 50–51*
- ▶ **PRODUCTION ASSISTANT** Acts as a general assistant on a film or TV production, carrying out basic tasks, such as carrying equipment and making deliveries. For hard-working and motivated individuals, this entry-level job can lead to further opportunities in the industry.
- ▶ **PROGRAM RESEARCHER** Contributes ideas for programs, sourcing contacts and contributors. Program researchers also collect, verify, and prepare information for film, TV, and radio productions.

The most successful producers are often paid a percentage of a film's box-office takings.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Film • TV • Drama • Theater • Photography • Videography • Crafts and design technology • English • History • Arts • Economics



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS There are no defined entry qualifications. A degree in film production or similar is useful, and a showreel of work is essential.



LIFESTYLE Producers work long and irregular hours to ensure that projects finish on time. Working during weekends and holidays is common.



LOCATION Based in an office, producers need to travel to studios, casting sessions, and to oversee location shoots, some of which may be abroad.



THE REALITIES Finding work is tough in this competitive industry. Balancing the creative, practical, and financial aspects of a project can be stressful.